EXPLOITS UNIVERSITY
RESEARCH ETHICS APPLICATION FORM

The Research Ethics Application for Defense Form (REAF) should be completed by:

- Bachelor's students undertaking undergraduate final year dissertation or projects requiring relevant ethics review and consideration.
- Master's students in academic programmes with research-based dissertation / Thesis

The forms will be collected through the reception or the office of research coordinator

Important Notes:

- For students at all levels, a hand written version of the completed form should be submitted to the research coordinator after certified by all relevant authorities including: supervisor, Accounts department. Your supervisor will then review this and provide feedback commentary. Once initial approval is given, then the supervisor certifies by signing and will forward this for final approval by the Exploits University Research Ethics Committee (EUREC).

- The office of the registrar will stamp it and provide you with Approve latter after successfully defend your proposal.

- If you need to supply any supplementary material, not specifically requested by the application form, please do so in a separate document. Any additional document(s) should be clearly labelled and attached to this document.

- Please write your application and do not submit photocopy or scanned. Only hand written documents should be submitted to the Committee.

- If you have any queries completing the form, please address them to your dissertation / project supervisor.

Please submit to the research department. Please submit only a filled in copies; **do not** submit scanned paper copies of this application.

EXPLOITS UNIVERSITY RESEARCH ETHICS APPLICATION FORM

UREC USE ONLY

Application No

Date Received: …,../.. / 20…

Student's Name: ……

Student's E-mail Address: ……

Student's ID #: ……

Supervisor's Name: ……

University Campus: ……

Program of Study: ……

Research Project Title: ……...

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1. External Research Funding:

a. Do you have any external funding for your research?

Yes ☐ No ☐

If YES, please answer questions 1b and 1c

b. Please list any external (third party) sources of funding you plan to utilize for your project. You need to include full details on the source of funds (e.g. state, private or individual sponsor), any prior / existing or future relationships between the funding body / sponsor and any of the principal investigator(s) or co-investigator(s) or student researcher(s), status and timeline of the application and any conditions attached (maximum 100 words).

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c. If there are any perceived ethical issues or potential conflicts of interest arising from applying for and receiving external funding for the proposed research then these need to be fully disclosed below (maximum 100 words).

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2. The research project

2a. Project Summary:

In this section please fully describe the purpose and underlying rationale for the proposed research project. Ensure that you pose the research questions to be examined, state the hypotheses, and discuss the expected results of your research and their potential. It is important in your description to use plain language so it can be understood by all members of the EUREC, especially those who are not necessarily experts in the particular discipline. To that effect, please ensure that you fully explain / define any technical terms or discipline-specific terminology (maximum 300 words +/- 10%).

2b. Provide details of the research setting (case study) (i.e. school, company) and location at which you will apply your research project (maximum 200 words).

3. Project execution:

3a. The following study is an (please tick one):

- ☐ experimental study (primary research)
- ☐ desktop study (secondary research)
- ☐ desktop study using existing databases involving information of human/animal subjects
- ☐ Other

If you have chosen 'Other', please Explain:

3b. Methods. The following study will involve the use of:

Method	Materials / Tools
☐ Qualitative	☐ Face to Face Interviews ☐ Phone Interviews ☐ Face to Face Focus Groups ☐ Online Focus Groups ☐ Other *
☐ Quantitative	☐ Self-administered Questionnaires ☐ Online Questionnaires ☐ Experiments ☐ Tests ☐ Other *

*If you have chosen 'Other' please Explain:

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3c. Describe how you will analyse your data (maximum 200 words).

3d. Describe the expected results of your research project (maximum 150 words).

4. Participants

4a. Does the Project involve the recruitment and participation of additional persons other than student/researcher?

☐ YES **If YES, please complete all following sections.**

☐ NO **If NO, please directly proceed to Question 5.**

Note: The definition of "participation" includes active participation, such as when participants knowingly take part in an interview or complete a questionnaire.

4b. Relevant Details of the Participants of the Proposed Research

Please state the number of participants you plan to recruit, and describe important characteristics such as: demographics (e.g. age, gender, location, affiliation, level of fitness, intellectual ability etc). It is also important that you specify any inclusion and exclusion criteria that will be applied (e.g. eligibility criteria for participants).

Number of participants

Age range From To

Gender ☐ Female

☐ Male

Eligibility Criteria:

- Inclusion criteria
- Exclusion criteria

Disabilities

Other relevant information (maximum 100 words):

4c. Recruitment Process for Human Research Participants:

Please clearly describe how the potential participants will be identified, approached and recruited (maximum 200 words).

4d. Research Participants Informed Consent.

Select below which categories of participants will participate in the study. Complete the relevant Informed Consent form and submit it along with the REAF form.

Yes	No	Categories of participants	Form to be completed
☐	☐	Typically Developing population(s) above the maturity age *	Informed Consent Form
☐	☐	Typically Developing population(s) under the maturity age *	Guardian Informed Consent Form

* Maturity age is defined by national regulations in laws of the country in which the research is being conducted.

4e. Relationship between the principal investigator and participants.

Is there any relationship between the principal investigator (student), co-investigators(s), (supervisor) and participant(s)? For example, if you are conducting research in a school environment on students in your classroom (e.g. instructor-student).

☐ YES ☐ NO

If YES, please specify (maximum 100 words):

5. Potential Risks of the Proposed Research Study

5a. Are there any potential risks, psychological harm and/or ethical issues associated with the proposed research study, other than risks pertaining to everyday life events (such as the risk of an accident when travelling to a remote location for data collection)?

☐ YES ☐ NO

If YES, please specify (maximum 150 words).

5b. Please choose the appropriate option:

		Yes	No
i.	Will you obtain written informed consent form from all participants?	☐	☐
ii.	Does the research involve as participants, people whose ability to give free and informed consent is in question?	☐	☐
iii.	Does this research involve participants who are children under maturity age? **If you answered YES to question iii, please complete all following questions.** **If you answered NO to question iii, please do not answer Questions iv, v, vi and proceed to Questions vii, viii, ix and x.**	☐	☐
iv.	Will the research tools be implemented in a professional educational setting in the presence of other adults (i.e. classroom in the presence of a teacher)?	☐	☐
v.	Will informed consent be obtained from the legal guardians (i.e. parents) of children?	☐	☐
vi.	Will verbal assent be obtained from children?	☐	☐
vii.	Will all data be treated as confidential? If NO, please explain why confidentiality of the collected date is not appropriate for this proposed research project, providing details of how all participants will be informed of the fact that any data which they will provide will not be confidential.	☐	☐
viii.	Will all participants/datacollected be anonymous? If NO, explain why and describe the procedures to be used to ensure the anonymity of participants and/or confidentiality of the collected data both during the conduct of the research and in the subsequent release of its findings.	☐	☐

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		Yes	No
ix.	Have you ensured that personal data and research data collected from participants will be securely stored for five years?	☐	☐
x.	Does this research involve the deception of participants? If YES, please describe the nature and extent of the deception involved. Explain how and when the deception will be revealed, and who will administer this debrief to the participants:	☐	☐

5c. Are there any other ethical issues associated with the proposed research study that are not already adequately covered in the preceding sections?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If YES, please specify (maximum 150 words).

5d. Please indicate the Risk Rating.

☐ High ☐ Low

6. <u>Further Approvals</u>

Are there any other approvals required (in addition to ethics clearance from UREC) in order to carry out the proposed research study?

☐ YES ☐ NO

If YES, please specify (maximum 100 words).

7. Data collection and management (storage, access and disposal of research data)

Please mark √ all that apply:

- ☐ All participants will be anonymous.
- ☐ All data will be treated as confidential.
- ☐ Numbers or pseudonyms will be used for all names of people, places or organisations in order to ensure anonymity.
- ☐ Numbers or pseudonyms linked to names of people, places or organisations will be securely stored.
- ☐ I confirm that my research records will be held securely.
- ☐ Data and/or electronic data will be stored for 5 years on a personal computer and the computer will be password protected/encrypted, so will any document files.
- ☐ All paper data will be destroyed and all electronic data will be completely deleted 5 years after the end of the project.
- ☐ Only the researcher and the Supervisor of this study will have access to the data collected.
- ☐ I confirm that a Gatekeeper's letter (uploaded on the VLE course platform) will be provided to the appropriate Institution (school, principal, company Director etc.

8. Reporting of results

8a. Will the project outcomes be made public at the end of the project?

☐ Yes If YES, describe the intended report and how and to whom it will be made available.

☐ No If NO, explain why not (maximum 250 words).

8b. Will report(s) of the project outcomes be made available to participants at the end of the project?

☐ Yes If YES, describe the intended report and how it will be made available.

☐ No If NO, explain why not (maximum 250 words).

9. Application Checklist

Please mark √ if the study involves any of the following:

☐ Children and young people under 18 years of age, vulnerable populations such as children with special educational needs (SEN), racial or ethnic minorities, socioeconomically disadvantaged, pregnant women, elderly, malnourished people, and ill people.

☐ Research that foresees risks and disadvantages that would affect any participant of the study such as anxiety, stress, pain or physical discomfort, harm risk (which is more than is expected from everyday life) or any other act that participants might believe is detrimental to their wellbeing and / or has the potential to / will infringe on their human rights / fundamental rights.

☐ Risk to the well-being and personal safety of the student.

☐ Administration of any substance (food / drink / chemicals / pharmaceuticals / supplements / chemical agent or vaccines or other substances (including vitamins or food substances) to human/animal participants.

☐ Results that may have an adverse impact on the natural or built environment.

10. Further documents

Please check that the following documents are attached to your application:

		ATTACHED	NOT APPLICABLE
1	Recruitment advertisement (if any)	☐	☐
2	Informed Consent Form / Guardian Informed Consent Form	☐	☐
3	Research Tool(s)	☐	☐
4	Gatekeeper Letter	☐	☐
5	Any other approvals required in order to carry out the proposed research study, e.g., institutional permission (e.g. school principal or company director) or approval from a local ethics or professional regulatory body.	☐	☐

11. Final Declaration by Applicants

a) I declare that this application is submitted on the basis that the information it contains is confidential and will only be used by Exploits University for the explicit purpose of ethical review and monitoring of the conduct of the research proposed project as described in the preceding pages.

b) I understand that this information will not be used for any other purpose without my prior consent, excluding use intended to satisfy reporting requirements to relevant regulatory bodies.

c) The information in this form, together with any accompanying information, is complete and correct to the best of my knowledge and belief and I take full responsibility for it.

d) I undertake to abide by the highest possible international ethical standards governing the Code of Practice for Research Involving Human Participants, as published by the UN WHO Research Ethics Review Committee (ERC) on http://www.who.int/ethics/research/en/ and to which Exploits University aspires to

e) In addition to respect any and all relevant professional bodies' codes of conduct and/or ethical guidelines, where applicable, while in pursuit of this research project.

f) I will report any changes affecting the ethical aspects of the project to the Exploits University Research Ethics Committee (UREC). Note: In the case of student projects, the responsibility lies with the Faculty Dissertation / Project Supervisor.

g) I will report any adverse or unforeseen events which might occur to the relevant Exploits University Research Ethics Committee (UREC). Note: In the case of student projects, the responsibility lies with the Faculty Dissertation/Project Supervisor.

☐ I agree with all points listed under Question 11

STUDENT'S NAME:

STUDENT SIGNATURE:

DATE OF APPLICATION

SUPERVISOR'S NAME:

SIGNATURE:

DATE OF APPROVAL:

COMMENTS

Important Note: Please proceed to the finance department for financial clearance of any outstanding balance in line with the dissertations

OFFICIAL USE

Dissertation Fee Paid	Any School Fees Balance	Finance Officer Signature
YES ☐ NO ☐	YES ☐ NO ☐	……

EXPLOITS UNIVERSITY APPROVAL

Official Stamp

Principal or Registrar

APPROVED ☐ PARTIARLY APPROVED ☐ NOT APPROVED ☐

EUREC COMMITTEE CHAIRPERSON

_____ Date _____

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